

AFIFAH KASHIF

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge

June 2026

MPhil in Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence; *Distinction*

Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Hatice Gunes)

Highlighted Courses: Responsible AI, Neuroscience & AI, Algorithms for Human-AI Collaboration, Ethics of AI

University of Washington (UW) – Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

June 2025

B.S. Computer Science; GPA: 3.77/4.0, *Dean's List*

Minor: Law, Societies & Justice, *Graduated 1 year early*

Highlighted Courses: AI/Computer Ethics, Distributed Systems, Law in Society, Machine Learning, AI, Algorithms

Capstone Project: [Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users](#)

Study Abroad: Rome Italy, Jan - Mar 2024, Honors: The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora

*received A.A. Arts and Science and A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences in tandem to high school for dual credit from Bellevue College (GPA: 3.98/4.0, Dean's List)

SELECT HONORS AND AWARDS

Cambridge Excellence Award - Top 5 Nominee

2026

Winner - LLM and Law Research Pitch [Cambridge Business School x Stanford LiftLab]

2026

Marcy Migdal Fellowship + Fund for Educational Equity, UW Center for Global Study, \$1500

2025

Distinguished Leader Award, Harvard WECODE

2023

Received multiple merit-based scholarships totaling \$17500

RESEARCH

Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio) [Submitted]

Avijit Ghosh, **Afifah Kashif**, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Vision-Language-Action Models Need Neuroscience's Evaluation Toolkit, Not Just Its Architectures

NeurIPS 2026 Position Paper Track [Submitted]

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, **Afifah Kashif**, Asim Iqbal

Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation

UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track

Afifah Kashif

Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human Robot Interaction

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2026

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.01503

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2025

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Applications Workshop @ Association for Information Science & Technology (ASIS&T) 2024

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

**equal contribution*

Broadening Participation in Computing by Designing Hackathons that Engage Local Communities

CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (Workshop Host; first and only undergraduate level team)

Afifah Kashif, Andrew Tran, Salma Aly, Egi Rama, Chiku Okechukwu

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Odyssean Institute, *Civic, Open & Resilient Democracy Action Democracy Fellowship* Apr 2026 – Present

- Coding expert responses, extracting causal variables, and building causal loop diagrams for AI governance horizon scan
- Applying Python-based analysis and LLM APIs to process input at scale for decision support tools in 2026 UK assembly

PluralisticAI Lab, *Research Assistant (Dr. Zhenzhen Qi [UConn], Dr. Avijit Ghosh [Hugging Face])* Mar 2026 – Present

- Co-designing a controlled human subjects study evaluating whether an open-source, multi-persona LLM platform reduces political polarization and improves conceptual understanding among users
- Developing IRB protocol, measurement instruments, and qualitative analysis framework for a 30+ participant study

Teaching (Various), *Supervisor, Course Founder, Teaching Assistant Roles* Sep 2023 – Mar 2026

- Led and held various supervisory and teaching initiatives across the **University of Cambridge**, **University of Washington**, **Stanford Code in Place** and in **Rome**, ranging in subjects from computer science, digital literacy, and language proficiency
- Launched digital literacy program for refugee women w/ **International Rescue Committee**, Kabul Community Services Seattle

HelloRobot, *Robotics Software Engineering Intern (UX + Human Robot Interaction)* May 2025 – Aug 2025

- Designed an interactive dashboard and workflow for an assistive in-home robot, iteratively prototyped and user-tested for trust, reliability, and operator agency
- Evaluated assistive robot behaviors through real-world user studies and healthcare data analysis, identifying failure modes in autonomous decision-making

Wordplay Project @ UW Information School, *Research Assistant (Dr. Amy Ko)* Sep 2024 – June 2025

- Led design and deployment of accessible, multilingual programming language learning platform in local schools
- Conducted literature reviews and usage analysis to create educational governance and ethical development structure

HowellCo¹, **Code.org²**, **Fiveable³** *Internships [Software Engineering^{1,2}, Operations/Product³]* April 2021 – Sep 2024

- ¹Built and tested backend infrastructure for a mobile app (Python, Azure, React)
- ²Developed and designed full-stack web-based coding lab, improving educational access for marginalized students
- ³Scaled internal operations and product workflows through company's transition into a consumer platform

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Cambridge AI Research Society, *AI Research Events Lead* Jan 2026 – Present

Coordinated with Google Deepmind, Microsoft Research, Mistral AI and other industry partners to coordinate speaker events

Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity, *Academic Representative* Oct 2025 – Present

Ensured a fulfilling interdisciplinary experience for students in the University of Cambridge's Centre for the Study of Existential Risk, Leverhulme Centre for the Future of Intelligence and Centre for Human-inspired AI

Researcher, *EvalEval Coalition* Sep 2025 – Present

Participating in global coalition of interdisciplinary researchers in coalition on AI evaluations, see published [blog post](#)

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute, *Scholar* June 2025 – Sep 2025

[Inaugural cohort](#) on Nordic practices in sustainability, governance, and innovation through trust-based, collaborative leadership

UW Pakistani Student Association, *President* Sep 2023 – June 2025

UW Women in Law Society, *Vice President and Co-Founder* May 2023 – May 2025

Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, *Executive Officer* Nov 2022 – Sep 2024

TechTogether Seattle MLH Hackathon, *Programming and Outreach* June 2022 – May 2023

Hosted Seattle's first women-only hackathon, nation's largest hackathon initiative addressing gender inequities in tech

Council of American-Islamic Relations, *Youth Advisory Board* Nov 2021 – April 2023

Worked with WA State Governor Jay Inslee and non-profit to ensure equitable experiences for Muslims and Afghan refugees

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming Languages: Java, JavaScript, Python, HTML/CSS, Node.js, C/C++, Ruby, TypeScript, React, SQL

Frameworks & Tools: ROS, Azure, AWS, PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, Ollama, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy

Research Methods: Agreement Analysis, Experimental Design, Qualitative Coding, User Studies, Literature Review